COMPLIANCE & SECURITY · CHECKLIST

Security Questionnaire Readiness Checklist

For revenue and operations leaders who need to respond to customer security reviews quickly and consistently instead of scrambling deal by deal.

> How to use this: Draft a standing answer for each item below, store it in one shared location, and update it whenever a practice changes.

Data and Access Fundamentals

- [ ] Where is customer data hosted, and in which regions?
- [ ] Who inside the company can access customer data, and how is that access controlled?
- [ ] How is customer data encrypted, both in transit and at rest?
- [ ] What is the process for provisioning and removing employee access to systems holding customer data?
- [ ] Is multi-factor authentication required for access to production and customer data?

Vendors, Subprocessors, and Data Flow

- [ ] What third-party tools or subprocessors touch customer data, and for what purpose?
- [ ] Is there a current list of subprocessors that can be shared with customers on request?
- [ ] Are subprocessor agreements in place that require equivalent data protection standards?
- [ ] Is customer data ever used for purposes beyond delivering the product (e.g., model training, analytics)?

Continuity, Backup, and Incident Response

- [ ] How often is customer data backed up, and how is a restore tested?
- [ ] What is the process if a security incident or data exposure is suspected?
- [ ] Is there a named contact and timeline for notifying affected customers of an incident?
- [ ] What is the disaster recovery plan if core infrastructure becomes unavailable?

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Certifications and Formal Frameworks

Do we currently hold any certifications (SOC 2, ISO 27001, etc.)? If not, what's the honest plan and timeline?

Have we ever completed a third-party penetration test or security audit? When, and what were the results?

What is our accurate, agreed-upon answer when a customer asks for a certification we don't yet have?

Readiness Tracker

Track how prepared you are to answer the most common question categories today.

Question Category	Answer Ready? (Y / N)	Owner	Last Updated
Data hosting & encryption			
Access control			
Subprocessors & vendors			
Backup & continuity			
Incident response			
Certifications			

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